SENIOR PM · CASE STUDY · MAY 2026

topi —
Seller Penetration

Three problems at three funnel stages. One prioritized bet. A concrete plan to 2× financed GMV without a single new customer.

A

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TOPI TODAY

1.5%

MARKET AVERAGE

3%

seller penetration rate

WHO I AM

Ahmed Sulaiman

Senior Product Manager

I work at the intersection of **data**, **channel economics**, and **product strategy** — turning complex multi-stakeholder environments into clear, executable roadmaps.

I want to join topi to solve real problems at the intersection of **B2B hardware financing** and **channel economics**. The activation gap is real. This case study is my take on how we close it.

OUTSIDE WORK

- Running
- Bouldering
- Hiking
- Polyglott
- Cooking
- Networking
- Community

IN THIS PRESENTATION

What we'll cover

SECTION 01

The Problem

Three funnel stages · three different timelines

THE SETUP

Three problems. Three funnel stages.

01 · TOP OF FUNNEL

1.5%

seller penetration rate

Market average is 3%. Room to 2× GMV with zero new customers.

SIGNAL IN 1–2 WEEKS

02 · MID FUNNEL

25%

hard churn at contract end

50% buy out (cash event). Max upside: 25% more customers.

SIGNAL: 36 MONTHS

03 · ENTERPRISE

85%

loss rate on €50k+ deals

Industry is 30–40%. Losing in pre/post-sale, not price.

SIGNAL: 3–6 MONTHS

Each problem sits at a different funnel stage — different stakeholders, different timelines. **We need to choose.**

PROBLEM 01 · TOP OF FUNNEL

Seller Penetration

TODAY

1.5%

topi seller penetration

MARKET AVERAGE

3%

industry benchmark

> **Hitting 3% = 2× financed GMV.** No new customers. No new markets. No new integrations. The infrastructure is already in place.

ROOT CAUSES

1 **Incentive misalignment**

Rep commission is tied to revenue/margin — not payment method. Offering topi adds steps with no financial upside for the rep.

2 **No visibility**

Sellers cannot see their topi deal pipeline, attach rate, or conversion data. topi feels like a black box after checkout.

3 **Friction in the conversation**

Generating a quote requires leaving the current tool. Longer sales conversation = lower likelihood of offering it at all.

PROBLEM 02 · MID FUNNEL

End-of-Contract Lifecycle

50%	25%	25%
Buy out device	Return & leave	New device
Cash event	Hard churn	Upgrade

> **The JTBD has shifted.** Customers are not hiring topi to rent hardware. They are hiring topi to **avoid a large upfront CAPEX**. The 50% buyout confirms it.

Note: When O1 works, "same rate, new device" at month 34 becomes the next O1 lever.

WHY WE DEPRIORITIZE

Max 25% upside

Only the hard churn segment. The 50% who bought are generating cash — not a loss.

6–36 months minimum to track

Cannot change existing contract terms. Invisible within 2 quarters.

Deprioritized

Monitor but do not actively resource. Return when O1 validates the reseller channel.

PROBLEM 03 · ENTERPRISE

Large Deal Close Rate

TODAY

15%

close rate on €50k+ deals

HEALTHY B2B RANGE

30–40%

industry benchmark

2.67× growth potential in enterprise. PEAC acquisition is a direct unlock — credibility today, partner network tomorrow.

WHERE WE'RE LOSING

Not price. Pre/post-sale services — onboarding complexity, contract terms, insurance requirements, procurement documentation. We're in the pipeline but lose in the operational depth phase.

PEAC CONTEXT

Today: institutional credibility — "Is topi financially stable?" answered with zero product work. **Later:** PEAC's partner network is a structural unlock. We park this as a future lever.

Ranked #2. Real opportunity, but 3–6 month signal window + multi-team process restructuring required.

SECTION 02

Our Data Lens

No internal data. Zero assumptions. One very clear answer.

TOPI TODAY

1.5%

seller penetration rate
across integrated partners

MARKET AVERAGE

3%

industry benchmark
across comparable platforms

The gap is not a product gap. It is a motivation gap. **This is not a demand problem. It is an activation problem.**

KEY INSIGHT

The job has shifted — and the data proves it

50%	6m–36m	0
BUY OUT AT CONTRACT END	PLANNED TO OWN FROM DAY ONE	ACTUAL CHURN — IT'S A CASH EVENT

OLD ASSUMPTION

"Customers hire topi to rent hardware on an ongoing basis."

→ Optimise for renewals. Treat the 50% buyout as churn.

→

WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

"Customers hire topi to **avoid large upfront CAPEX**. They planned to own the device from day one."

→ The 50% buyout isn't churn. It's proof of financing behaviour.

NEW SELLER SCRIPT · *"Avoid CAPEX, stay liquid, get the hardware you need today. Pay over 36 months."*

SECTION 03

The Decision

O2 deprioritized · O3 ranked second · O1 is the bet

WE CHOOSE 01 — SELLER PENETRATION

Three reasons. No tradeoffs.

1

Fastest feedback loop Signal in 2 weeks

Partners are already integrated. No upfront engineering required. First signal in 1–2 weeks, comparing against last year's quarter.

2

Highest leverage 2× GMV potential

Doubling penetration from 1.5% to 3% doubles financed GMV with the current partner base. **No new customers. No new markets. No new integrations.**

3

We control it Internal lever

This is an internal incentive and process adjustment — not dependent on end-user behavior change or compliance timelines. **We can move without external approvals.**

DECISION FRAMEWORKS

Two frameworks. One convergent answer.

FRAMEWORK 1 · JTBD

Jobs-to-be-Done

The job has shifted from "rent hardware" to "avoid CAPEX." This tells us what the seller conversation should sound like — and why the 50% buyout is a signal, not a loss.

> THE SELLER PITCH REFRAME
>
> *"Get the hardware you need today. No large upfront cost. Stay liquid. Pay over 36 months."*

FRAMEWORK 2 · CHANNEL ECONOMICS

The Motivation Gap

The gap between 1.5% and 3% is not a product gap. Sellers who are motivated and enabled close topi deals. Those who aren't — don't. We fix the motivation layer.

Motivated + enabled seller	~3% penetration
Unmotivated seller	~0.5% penetration

SECTION 04

The Plan

4 features · 3 success phases · kill switch at day 45

HOW WE DEFINE SUCCESS

Three phases. One kill switch.

1

Launch DAYS 1–14

Launch SPIFF to top-performing partners. Establish baseline metrics.

TRACK

New deal requests vs. baseline · Quote attachment rate

2

Validate DAYS 15–45

Is activation changing? Are more reps offering topi mid-conversation?

TRACK

Reseller activation rate · Quote attachment rate · Calculator usage

3

Scale MONTHS 3–6

Are we moving toward 3% seller penetration?

TRACK

Seller penetration % · Financed GMV (€)

KILL SWITCH · DAY 45

If day-45 shows <10% change in reseller activation → stop. Revisit the blocker hypothesis. Problem may be pre-qual friction, not incentives. **We do not wait 6 months to find out.**

Four features. Ordered by impact vs. effort.

#	FEATURE	ENGINEERING	IMPACT	SHIPS
01	**Tiered Seller SPIFF Program** Cash bonus directly to the rep for every topi-financed deal closed	Low	Very High	Immediately
02	**Email Campaign Kit** Pre-built B2B templates sellers send to their existing customer list	Low	Medium-High	Week 1–2
03	**Pipeline Dashboard** Real-time deal-stage view per reseller — data already in backend	Medium	High	Q2
04	**Live Quote Generator** 30-second shareable topi quote mid-conversation, for every reseller	High	Medium	Q2–Q3

FEATURE 01 · SHIPS IMMEDIATELY

Tiered Seller SPIFF Program

DEAL SIZE	REP BONUS
< €5k	€20–€50 flat
€5k – €20k	€100–€250
€20k – €50k	€300–€450
> €50k	€500–€1,000 + quarterly prize pool

> **Why it changes behavior:** Bonus goes to the rep directly — not the company. Offering topi now has a clear personal financial upside. The "why would I add steps?" objection disappears.

STAKEHOLDER VIEW

Sales Rep / Channel Partner

Root blocker

JTBD: Make me earn more per deal without adding complexity. **Blocker:** Commission tied to revenue/margin — no incentive to offer topi.

VP of Partnership

Sponsor

JTBD: Hit GMV targets without adding headcount. **Blocker:** Slow corporate incentive structures can't motivate individual reps at scale.

Head of Engineering

Phase 2

JTBD: Prioritise eng resources on highest business impact per sprint. **Note:** v1 needs zero engineering. Phase 2 dashboard reads existing CRM data.

FEATURES 02 + 03

Email Campaign Kit + Pipeline Dashboard

FEATURE 02 · EMAIL CAMPAIGN KIT · WEEK 1–2

Pre-built email templates sellers send to existing B2B customer lists. Zero creative effort from partners. Phase 2: AI-personalized campaigns using existing contract data.

For Reseller / Partner

JTBD: Re-engage dormant customers without writing a single email myself. **Blocker:** No bandwidth for custom campaigns. Zero brand assets from topi today.

Engineering v1: Zero · Phase 2 reads existing contract data

FEATURE 03 · PIPELINE DASHBOARD · Q2

Real-time view per reseller — deals in checkout, abandoned, in credit review, closed. Lets sellers follow up at exactly the right moment.

For Sales Rep · Product Lead

JTBD: Tell me exactly when to follow up — show me topi isn't a black box. **Blocker:** Zero visibility into deal stage after checkout. Data exists but no UI surface.

Engineering: UI layer only — data already exists in backend

FEATURE 04 + STAKEHOLDERS

Live Quote Generator + Who We Need

FEATURE 04 · LIVE QUOTE GENERATOR · Q2–Q3

Rep enters device, deal size, customer name → shareable topi financing quote in 30 seconds, mid-conversation, without leaving the sales flow.

> Currently only exists inside ITscope and SYNAXON. This brings the 30-second quote to every reseller regardless of integration tier.

Sales Rep (all tiers)

JTBD: Give me a shareable quote I can show the customer in the room. **Blocker:** Current flow requires leaving the sales tool. Longer = less likely.

Engineering: Frontend + pricing engine + credit check API hook

ALL STAKEHOLDERS — FULL MAP

Sales Rep / Reseller

Root cause

JTBD: Earn more, close faster, look good. Blocker: no incentive, no visibility, high friction.

VP of Partnership

Sponsor

JTBD: Scale GMV without re-negotiating every partner contract. Blocker: slow corporate structures.

Product Lead

Enabler

JTBD: Ship partner features without new data infrastructure. Blocker: eng bandwidth competes.

Head of Engineering

Phase 2

JTBD: Prioritise eng on highest-impact features. Blocker: Quote generator needs pricing engine + credit check hook — scoped but significant.

SECTION 05

Ship the SPIFF.
Validate in 45 days.

Zero engineering for v1 · First signal week 2 · Go/no-go day 45

SUMMARY

The full picture at a glance

	O1: SELLER PENETRATION	O2: LIFECYCLE	O3: ENTERPRISE
CURRENT	1.5% penetration	50% buyout / 25% churn	15% close rate
TARGET	3% (market avg)	—	30–40%
TIME TO SIGNAL	2 weeks	36 months	3–6 months
LEVERAGE	Internal	External	Mixed
PRIORITY	#1 · Start now	Deprioritized	#2

> We start with O1. We use O1's GMV growth to fund and justify O3. O2 is monitored but not actively resourced.

THE BET + KILL SWITCH

We are betting hard on resellers.

IF WE ARE RIGHT

- ✓ Day-15: new deal requests increase above baseline
- ✓ Day-45: sustained activation confirmed across partners
- ✓ Month 6: seller penetration moving toward 3%
- ✓ GMV growth funds O3 enterprise initiative

KILL SWITCH AT DAY 45

- ✕ <10% change in reseller activation rate
- ✕ Revisit root cause — may be pre-qual friction, not incentives
- ✕ Next move: prioritize Live Quote Generator to reduce conversation friction
- ✕ **We do not wait 6 months to find out.**

ENGINEERING APPROACH

How we build on top of what we have

01 **SPIFF Automation**
Data flows, automated onboarding, reminder cadence. Wire to existing CRM — no new infrastructure.

02 **Pipeline Dashboard**
Aggregate deal-stage events per partner ID. Surface via clean UI. Data already exists in backend.

03 **Email Campaign Kit**
Design + copy only for v1. Zero engineering. Phase 2: AI personalization on existing contract data.

04 **Live Quote Generator**
Frontend tool + pricing engine + credit check API hook. Output: shareable link or PDF. Clearly scoped.

→ **For each component**
Frontend scope · Backend scope · Integrations · Analytics setup · User impact · Technical connections.

∞ **Shared infrastructure**
Partner Auth · Deal Event Bus · Notification Service · Partner Data Store · Analytics — built once, used by all four.

CASE STUDY QUESTIONS

Three questions. Three honest answers.

QUESTION 01

Why do sellers avoid topi today?

Because we do not incentivize them to hand us the market demand. Their commission is tied to revenue and margin — not payment method. Offering topi adds steps with no financial upside for the rep. The SPIFF program directly addresses this.

QUESTION 02

Which seller cohorts underperform?

We expect smaller resellers outside SYNAXON/ITscope networks and reps without prior financing experience. Post-SPIFF launch, we validate this with data segmented by partner size and rep tenure. The partner performance gap confirms the hypothesis is behavioral.

QUESTION 03

What % of financed quotes convert?

We will establish a pre-SPIFF baseline and measure the lift at day 15, day 45, and month 6. Quote attachment rate is the leading indicator. Financed GMV is the lagging one. Both are tracked from week 1.

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The demand is there. We just need to take it.

The 3% market average proves demand exists. It is an activation problem, not a demand problem. We start with O1, validate in 45 days, and use the signal to fund O3.

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Questions welcome